

— AN ISSUE ON GENDER / POWER / EVERYDAY LIFE

Misogyny

What we perceive & *what we overlook*. A critical exploration of gender, power, social norms and everyday life in Bangladesh.

GENDER

POWER

CULTURE

REPRESENTATION

EVERYDAY LIFE

THEORY Beauvoir, Connell, Foucault, Hall, Kandiyoti

CASE STUDY When women police women: the grandmother effect

VOICES Real anonymous testimonies from campus & home

“Who decided what a *good woman* should be?”

This magazine begins with expectations - not violence.



good daughter

good wife

modest

obedient

good mother

caring

respectable

beautiful

THE OTHER MARGIN COLLECTIVE / VOLUME 01

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THE MARGIN MANIFESTO

A student-run critical journal on the misogyny that is visible, and the misogyny that ordinary life teaches us to overlook. Theory, history, cases, and voices, printed on purpose.

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ISSUE STRUCTURE AT A GLANCE

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- pp. 07 & 22 Mechanisms: The six-stage cycle and social ecosystem
- pp. 08-14 Theory: Beauvoir, Connell, Foucault, Hall, Kandiyoti
- pp. 15-20 Case Studies: Policing, grandmother effect, dress, image
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- pp. 24-32 Reflections: Hard questions, poem, afterword, bibliography

— DEAR READER / A LETTER FROM THE DESK

The quiet kind

We usually recognize misogyny when it is loud - harassment, violence, abuse, openly hostile language. This issue is about the other register.

What about the advice that tells a girl how to dress? The expectation that a wife should sacrifice more? The assumption that a mother should put everyone before herself? The judgment of a woman who speaks too loudly, stays out too late, chooses not to marry, or prioritizes her career?

These practices may not always appear discriminatory. Sometimes they arrive dressed as tradition, protection, respectability, responsibility - or simply "the way things are."

This magazine asks what happens when such expectations are repeated so often that they become difficult to recognize as social constructions at all.

More importantly, we examine a difficult question: can women themselves reproduce misogynistic norms? Our answer is yes - but this does not mean blaming women for patriarchy. It means examining how social norms are learned, internalized, negotiated and passed from one generation to another.

Through five theoretical perspectives, historical context, contemporary cases, interviews and critical reflection, *The Other Margin* looks at the misogyny that is visible - and the misogyny that ordinary life teaches us to overlook.



KHOLIPHA AHMMAD AL-AMIN / EDITOR IN CHIEF & LEAD STRATEGIST. DHAKA, 2026.

Founder & CEO, EquiSaaS BD / Software Engineer & AI Specialist

CORE DIAGNOSTIC QUESTION

"Can women themselves reproduce misogynistic norms?"

Hold this question through the theory pages. We return to it on pages 15, 16 and 24.

- Loud misogyny gets headlines. Quiet misogyny gets inherited.

MISOGYNY IS MORE THAN “HATING WOMEN”

A working definition

The dictionary will tell you misogyny means hatred or contempt toward women. Our publication uses a broader diagnostic understanding:
misogyny operates through hostility, devaluation, policing and punishment directed at women because they are women - especially when they challenge gendered expectations.

LOUD: DIRECT HOSTILITY	QUIET: NORMATIVE POLICING	STRUCTURAL: THE BASELINE
Street harassment & stalking	Judging volume, tone & laughter	Unequal inheritance division
Direct physical violence	Policing modesty & clothing	Uncompensated domestic care
Overt sexist insults & threats	Guilt for prioritizing career	Curfews framed as safety
Explicit workplace discrimination	Presumption that a wife must adjust	Family headship default to men

THEORETICAL ANCHOR / KATE MANNE (2017)

In *Down Girl: The Logic of Misogyny*, philosopher Kate Manne argues that misogyny is not a psychological hostility held in individual men's heads. It is the **law-enforcement branch of patriarchy**. Its primary purpose is not to hate all women indiscriminately, but to police the boundary: rewarding women who comply with subordination, and punishing women who claim equal authority, autonomy, or voice.

The quiet column is longer. *That is the point.*

DIAGNOSTIC PROMPT

When someone criticizes a woman's tone, clothing, or ambitions, ask: Is this a neutral observation, or is social judgment enforcing an unwritten rule?

Etymology: Greek *mīsos* (hatred) + *gunē* (woman). In modern sociology, broadened from private sentiment to systematic social regulation.

THREE CONCEPTS WE MUST SEPARATE

Not the same thing

These three words get used interchangeably in casual discussion. They shouldn't be. Each names a completely different level of social organization.

01 / SYSTEM

Patriarchy

The overarching social architecture of gendered power.

It organizes inheritance, lineage, family headship, and institutional authority. It predates any living individual and outlives individual goodwill.

02 / IDEOLOGY

Sexism

The cultural beliefs and stereotypes that justify inequality.

Operates through idioms, jokes, and proverbs that frame men as natural leaders and women as natural caretakers. It can be voiced affectionately and still constrain lives.

03 / ENFORCEMENT

Misogyny

The disciplinary mechanism that polices and punishes violations.

The active hostility, shaming, or social penalty applied when a woman steps outside prescribed boundaries or refuses subordination.

COMPARATIVE MATRIX / EVERYDAY MANIFESTATIONS IN BANGLADESH

REGISTER	ARENA	BANGLADESHI EVERYDAY EXAMPLE	ENFORCEMENT MODE
Patriarchy	Kinship & Law	Patrilocal marriage customs and property ownership concentration in male heirs.	Customary & civil statutes
Sexism	Cultural Idiom	Colloquial sayings like "meyeder eto kotha bolte nei" framing domesticity as innate virtue.	Language, media serials
Misogyny	Direct Policing	Online harassment mobs targeting women journalists, or relatives shaming unmarried working women.	Social sanction, reputational loss

CORE DIAGNOSTIC QUESTION

“How does a social system turn gender expectations into everyday behaviour?”

When power is woven into family affection, refusal looks like ingratitude. That is how the system endures.

— WHAT WE PERCEIVE - AND WHAT WE OVERLOOK

Ordinary is not the same as harmless

We immediately recognize the loud register: physical violence, overt sexual harassment, hostile threats, and workplace exclusion. Society agrees these are injustices.

But listen to what circulates without a legal code attached. Each of the sentences below may sound ordinary in a Dhaka drawing room. Ordinary does not mean harmless: it usually means thoroughly rehearsed.

“Good girls don’t behave like that.”

“A woman should know how to adjust.”

“Why was she outside so late?”

“A married woman should prioritize her family over herself.”

“Girls shouldn’t talk or laugh so loudly in public.”

“Women should dress respectfully if they want safety.”

“She is too ambitious for her own good.”

DIAGNOSTIC INQUIRIES

Who is always expected to adjust? Who defines what is “respectable”? Would the same rule ever apply to a man? What exact social price does a woman pay when she refuses?



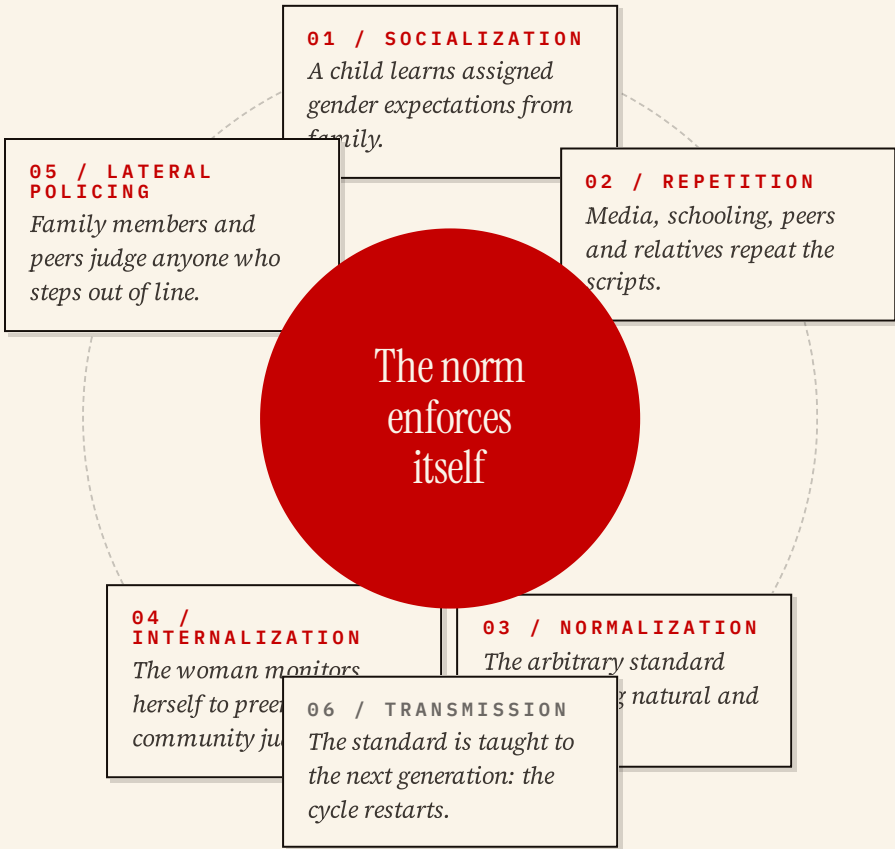
PLATE 01: MORNING, DHAKA. THE STREET NOTICES EVERYTHING AND JUDGES QUIETLY.

- Nobody in this photograph is committing a crime. That is precisely where gender norms live: in the unspoken expectations that govern posture, movement, and gaze.

Field Observation / Mirpur & Dhanmondi, 2026

— HOW DOES MISOGYNY REPRODUCE ITSELF?

The wheel nobody steers



The central sociological insight:

A social norm becomes indestructible when it no longer requires external force, *because people begin enforcing it on themselves.*

Once a cycle reaches self-enforcement, no central conspirator is required. Each turn of the wheel arrives disguised as common sense, good parenting, or moral responsibility.

THEORETICAL CONNECTION / MICHEL FOUCAULT

Disciplinary power does not rely solely on direct violence. It operates through continuous surveillance, normalizing judgment, and self-regulation. See detailed examination on page 11.

- Break any single spoke in this wheel, and the entire momentum slows down.

THEORETICAL FRAMEWORK / ANALYTICAL FOUNDATIONS

Five lenses, one problem

Instead of five disconnected biographies, five diagnostic instruments. Each thinker hands us a different analytical magnification to examine everyday life in Bangladesh.

LENS 01 / ONTOLOGY

Simone de Beauvoir (1949)

“Who gets to define ‘woman’?”

Deconstructs how woman is defined only in relation to man: as the 'Other' rather than an autonomous subject.

LENS 02 / STRUCTURE

R. W. Connell (1987, 2005)

“How does gender organize power?”

Analyzes the gender order and hegemonic masculinity, demonstrating how cultural dominance rewards male authority.

LENS 03 / DISCIPLINE

Michel Foucault (1975)

“How do we learn to regulate ourselves?”

Reveals panoptic surveillance: power moving into bodily posture, modesty codes, and internalized self-policing.

LENS 04 / DISCOURSE

Stuart Hall (1997)

“How do representations manufacture reality?”

Examines how media archetypes (the self-sacrificing wife, the fairness imperative) encode and naturalize dominant ideology.

LENS 05 / STRATEGY

Deniz Kandiyoti (1988)

“Why might women negotiate with constraint?”

Introduces the 'patriarchal bargain', explaining why women often accommodate restrictive systems to secure domestic safety, social protection, and family standing.

ANALYTICAL MATRIX / FIVE LEVELS OF EVERYDAY INQUIRY

THINKER	DOMAIN	CORE MECHANISM	APPLICATION IN BANGLADESH
Beauvoir	Identity & Role	Woman as Relative Other	The "good daughter / good wife" burden
Connell	Social Order	Hegemonic Masculinity	Double standards in campus ambition
Foucault	Body & Gaze	Panoptic Self-Discipline	Clothing and volume self-censorship
Hall	Media Representation	Signifying Cultural Codes	Television archetypes & fairness ads
Kandiyoti	Household Bargain	Strategic Accommodation	Why mothers police daughters for survival

SIMONE DE BEAUVOIR / 1949

Woman as the “Other”

B

Beauvoir’s analysis examines how woman is defined as relative to a male “Self” - rather than treated first and foremost as an autonomous subject.

In everyday life, this appears whenever a woman is introduced through her relations instead of herself: the good daughter, the good wife, the good mother. Each phrase contains a hidden preposition - good *to whom*?

The question becomes: is she being recognized for who she is - or for how well she performs the identity society has assigned to her?

ASK YOURSELF

When you last introduced a woman, whose relation did you introduce her through?

- “One is not born, but rather becomes, a woman.” - the sentence this whole issue leans on.

— BANGLADESH LENS

A GIRL
Be modest.

A WIFE
Adjust.

A MOTHER
Sacrifice.

A DAUGHTER
Obey.

The issue is not that caring, modesty or family responsibility are inherently bad. The issue is why these qualities become **moral requirements specifically for women**.

R. W. CONNELL / 1987 / 2005

The gender order



Connell treats gender as a social relationship and structure - not merely a personal identity. Her work on masculinities shows multiple masculinities positioned differently within relations of power; **hegemonic masculinity** names the culturally dominant configuration that legitimizes men's dominance.

MAN - THE EXPECTED LIST

provider/leader

strong/independent

decision-maker

WOMAN - THE EXPECTED LIST

caregiver/supporter

emotional/domestic

accommodating

These expectations create unequal social value. Watch the same behaviour get two names:

A confident man may be called assertive. **A confident woman** may be called aggressive.

A career-focused man may be called ambitious. **A career-focused woman** may be told she is neglecting her family.

ASK YOURSELF

Why can the same behaviour be praised in a man and criticized in a woman?

- Hegemonic masculinity also disciplines men who fall short of it - the order polices both sides of the ledger.

MICHEL FOUCAULT / 1975

When power enters the mirror



PLATE 02 - THE AUDIENCE MOVED INDOORS. SHE CHECKS HERSELF BEFORE ANYONE ELSE MUST.

Foucault helps us understand a particularly quiet form of power: **self-discipline**. His account of disciplinary power emphasizes observation, normalization and judgment as mechanisms through which people become regulated - the panopticon moved into everyday posture, clothing, and speech.

A VIGNETTE

Imagine a woman choosing clothes. Nobody tells her: "Change."



But she thinks: "What will people say?"



She changes. Nobody forced her.



Yet social judgment has already acted.

THE MOVEMENT

SOCIETY WATCHES / I ANTICIPATE JUDGMENT / I WATCH MYSELF / I REGULATE MYSELF

THE QUESTION

"If people learn to police themselves, does society still need to police them directly?"

STUART HALL / 1997

The woman we keep seeing



Representation is not simply about showing reality. It helps **construct** the conceptual systems through which reality is understood. Hall examines how images, language and cultural codes operate as signifying practices - repetition doing the ideological work of proof.



CASE STUDY 01 / TELEVISION DRAMA

The "Lokkhi Bou" Archetype

In classic Bangladeshi television serials and telefilms, virtuous womanhood is systematically encoded as self-effacing domestic service, emotional restraint, and silent endurance. Outspoken or ambitious women are framed as disruptive to family harmony. Through decades of primetime repetition, this trope naturalizes female compliance as moral virtue.



CASE STUDY 02 / COMMERCIAL MEDIA

The Fairness Imperative

Billboard and broadcast advertising across Dhaka markets skin lightening as a prerequisite for self-worth, respectability, and career advancement. Drawing on Hall's "Spectacle of the Other", dark skin is encoded as a personal lack to be remedied, while fairness is encoded as social mobility. Commercial media does not merely sell cream; it manufactures racialized gender norms.

ENCODING & DECODING / STUART HALL

Media texts encode dominant cultural ideologies. When audiences consume these images without critical resistance, they adopt the "preferred reading" - accepting that quiet, self-sacrificing behavior is what a woman naturally is, rather than what culture repeatedly demands she become.

CORE TAKEAWAY

A representation does not need to lie. It only needs to repeat until cultural construction is mistaken for nature.

DENIZ KANDIYOTI / 1988

The patriarchal bargain

K

Kandiyoti argues that women develop strategies within concrete patriarchal constraints. She calls these strategies “**patriarchal bargains**.” Different systems create different “rules of the game,” and women negotiate those rules to maximize security or life options.

— WHAT CONFORMITY CAN BUY

FAMILY
ACCEPTANCE

SECURITY

SOCIAL
STATUSECONOMIC
PROTECTIONREDUCED
CONFLICT

ASK YOURSELF

Whose consent is easiest to collect? The one who agrees - or the one for whom refusal is most expensive?

- This lens will do heavy work on page 24, when we ask whether women are part of the problem.

Does conformity always mean *agreement*?

Not necessarily. A woman may follow a traditional expectation because it steadies her life - while privately finding the rules unjust.

Therefore: **accommodation can be a strategy for survival, not proof that oppression is freely accepted.** This is why we should be careful before judging women who conform to patriarchal expectations. The bargain is made under conditions the bargainer did not set.

— APPLIED THEORY / SYNTHESIS ACROSS FIVE FRAMEWORKS

One woman, five theories

Scenario: **A married woman in Dhaka continues her corporate career while expecting shared domestic labor.** *Watch what each analytical framework illuminates.*

- 01 / BEAUVOIR

Relational Construction: Her husband's career is framed as standard breadwinning; hers is framed as an optional luxury that must never compromise domestic duties. When introduced at family gatherings, her professional credentials are overshadowed by whether she is a "cooperative daughter-in-law" (*lokkhi bou*).
- 02 / CONNELL

The Gender Order: Relatives warn the husband that sharing domestic chores diminishes his authority within the kinship network. Hegemonic masculinity disciplines both: she is penalized for ambition, while he is teased for being "controlled" if he cooks or does laundry.
- 03 / FOUCAULT

Panoptic Self-Surveillance: Nobody explicitly commands her to leave the office early. Yet she glances at her watch at 5:30 PM with acute anxiety, skips professional networking events, and perpetually apologizes for working late. The community gaze has entered her conscience.
- 04 / HALL

Representational Coding: Primetime television serials have trained everyone around her to associate career-oriented wives with familial neglect and conflict. Even when she manages both domains brilliantly, family members interpret her career through the pre-packaged media trope of the "selfish modern woman."
- 05 / KANDIYOTI

The Patriarchal Bargain: To neutralize family resistance and protect her career, she strikes an exhausting bargain: waking at 5:00 AM to cook meals before leaving for work, over-compensating domestically to purchase peace and legitimacy for her professional autonomy.

CORE SYNTHESIS CONCLUSION

One ordinary life decision contains identity construction, structural inequality, bodily surveillance, media coding, and strategic survival - operating at the exact same moment.

- When we understand these five forces together, we stop asking naive questions like "Why doesn't she just assert herself?" and begin seeing the structural matrix she must navigate every morning.

CASE STUDY
012025 / Bangladesh / online
audiences

When women police women

The 2025 controversy involving Bangladeshi model Tangia Zaman Methila shows misogynistic objectification circulating inside online audiences - including from women.

DO NOT MAKE THIS ARGUMENT

"Women are the real problem."

A lazy conclusion that flatters the structure by blaming its casualties.

ASK INSTEAD

What happens when women reproduce the same gendered standards that constrain women?

A woman can participate in: sexual objectification / body shaming / slut-shaming / appearance policing / moral judgment. Misogynistic norms can circulate between women as well as between men and women.

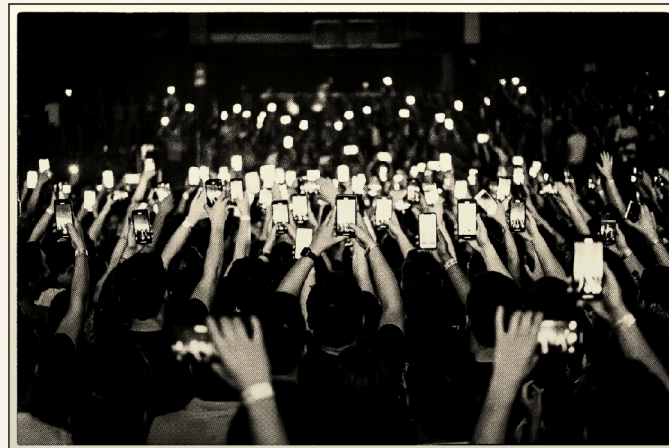


PLATE 03 - THE JURY THAT NEVER LEAVES THE ROOM. EACH SCREEN A SMALL COURTROOM.

KEEP THE DISTINCTION

Reproduction is not the same as origin. A woman reproducing a misogynistic norm does not mean she created the broader gender structure.

CASE STUDY 02

Grandmother / mother / daughter

The grandmother effect

GENERATION 01

Grandmother

*"Girls should
behave properly."*

GENERATION 02

Mother

*"This is how a
respectable woman
behaves."*

GENERATION 03

Daughter

*"This is simply
normal."*

Can someone who has experienced gender inequality also *reproduce* gender inequality?

Yes. Because people can simultaneously be constrained by a norm and be agents who reproduce that norm. This is not necessarily hypocrisy - it can be the ordinary arithmetic of socialization + internalization + normalization.



PLATE 04 - WHAT IS PASSED DOWN IS NOT ONLY JEWELLERY.

ASK YOURSELF

Which sentence from the previous generation do you still repeat - and would you defend it, or only perform it?

- The daughter who says "this is simply normal" is not lying. She is reporting her data.

— SPECIAL COLUMN

Protection, or control?



PLATE 05 - THE GRILL KEEPS THINGS OUT. IT ALSO KEEPS THINGS IN.

A parent says: “I’m restricting you
for your own safety.”

We should not immediately dismiss the concern. Women genuinely face safety risks, and love often stands behind the lock on the door.

But watch what happens to the question being asked. Instead of “**How can we make public spaces safer?**” it becomes “**Why was she outside?**” Instead of “**How do we prevent harassment?**” it becomes “**Why was she dressed like that?**”

The risk is real - but the remedy moves, quietly, from the conditions that produce insecurity to the woman who must live with it.

OUR CRITICAL QUESTION

When does protection become control?

Not every protective action is misogynistic. Protection becomes problematic when women’s freedom is disproportionately restricted while the underlying conditions producing insecurity remain unchallenged.

— BODILY AUTONOMY / MOVING BEYOND THE LIBERAL-CONSERVATIVE BINARY

Who gets to choose what a woman wears?

*The real question is never the garment itself. The real question is **agency**: who decides, who enforces the boundary, and what exact social price follows refusal.*

01 / VOLUNTARY HIJAB

Agency: A religious, cultural, or personal conviction that belongs entirely to the woman. When chosen freely, the garment represents an act of self-determination and personal dignity.

02 / FORCED CONFINEMENT

Coercion: When family members or local institutions mandate dress under threat of punishment, genuine autonomy is abolished regardless of the garment's religious meaning to others.

03 / COMMUNITY SHAMING

Street Surveillance: When a woman walking through Dhaka is harassed, slandered, or denied safety for wearing jeans or unpinned dupattas, social policing treats her body as public property.

04 / ELITE MOCKERY

Exclusionary Bias: When professional or academic spaces subtly diminish a woman's intellect because she wears a burqa or hijab, the pressure is equally coercive and paternalistic.

— THE DOUBLE-BIND IN URBAN BANGLADESH

Women across Bangladesh navigate an impossible tightrope: criticized if their clothing is perceived as "overly Western" or modern, and simultaneously dismissed if they wear traditional religious attire. This reveals the core mechanism: society claims jurisdiction over women's appearance, turning dress into an instrument of moral judgment rather than personal freedom.

Autonomy is not about looking modern. It is about *having the right to decide without fear.*

ANALYTICAL RULE

Avoid the simplistic formula where traditional equals oppressed and modern equals liberated. Freedom cannot be measured by the hem of a garment; it can only be measured by whether a woman had real sovereignty to choose.

— POLITICAL AUTHORITY / THE SOUTH ASIAN PARADOX

Can women lead without being judged as women?

Bangladesh presents a globally recognized political paradox: women have occupied the Prime Ministership for over three decades, yet ordinary women remain severely marginalized across local governance and corporate leadership.

— APEX POWER VS GRASSROOTS REALITY

Dynastic political succession has historically allowed exceptional women to command state authority in South Asia. However, symbolic representation at the summit frequently acts as an alibi: institutions point to female national leaders to deny that systemic patriarchy persists in corporate boardrooms, union halls, and university faculties.

A male leader showing firmness is praised as decisive and strong.

A female leader showing the same firmness is branded shrill, vindictive, or emotional.

— THE DOUBLE STANDARD CHECKLIST

Notice which categories of scrutiny attach exclusively to women in public life:

- VOCAL TONE
- MARITAL STATUS
- CHILDCARE DUTIES
- CLOTHING CHOICES
- EMOTIONAL DEMEANOR
- PHYSICAL AGE
- LAUGH VOLUME

Connell's gender order and Hall's media framing intersect here: legitimate policy critique is displaced by gendered personal devaluation.

LEGITIMATE CRITIQUE VS GENDERED POLICING

Holding a public official accountable for fiscal policy, human rights, or administrative competence is essential democratic practice. Questioning her right to exercise authority because of her gender, marital state, or appearance is misogyny wearing the mask of politics.

CORE DIAGNOSTIC

“Would this exact criticism ever be leveled against a man in the same position?”

— SOVEREIGNTY, SPECTATORSHIP, AND THE COMMERCIAL GAZE

Who owns a woman’s image?

When a woman asserts herself in public culture, society immediately divides her image into competing moral and commercial claims. The inquiry is neither puritanical nor consumerist: it examines who exercises sovereignty over the meaning of her visibility.

TENSION I / SUBJECTHOOD	TENSION II / SEMIOTICS	TENSION III / MATERIALITY
Agency vs The Gaze	Expression vs Sexualization	Choice vs Precarity
Does the creative act originate from internal aesthetic desire, or is it structured by an anticipatory compliance with what an external spectator rewards? Autonomy requires that the subject defines her own exposure rather than conforming to an audience's appetite.	Audiences frequently project sexualization onto images intended as art, athletic discipline, or fashion sovereignty. Society often holds the creator guilty for the voyeuristic gaze of the viewer, conflating the woman's presentation with the viewer's consumption.	In a digital attention economy, visibility converts directly into livelihood. When cultural industries systematically penalize quiet craft and over-reward hyper-visible bodily performance, individual choice is heavily disciplined by material survival and platform incentives.

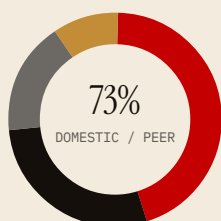
— METHODOLOGICAL LENS: FOUR SITES OF IMAGE POLITICS

SITE OF PRODUCTION	SITE OF THE IMAGE	SITE OF CIRCULATION	SITE OF AUDIENCING
Who held the camera, drafted the contract, funded the project, and retained final editorial cut? Power resides in the conditions of production.	What formal visual codes, lighting techniques, and postures are mobilized? Does the framing treat the body as an active agent or a static ornament?	How do social platform algorithms extract engagement from moral outrage? Algorithmic systems weaponize women's visibility to maximize clicks and commentary.	Does the spectator encounter the subject with relational respect or punitive moralism? Audiences actively decode images through their own ideological filters.

A woman’s visibility does not automatically signify exploitation, nor does an audience’s voyeurism prove that her expression lacked agency. True sovereignty begins when we stop treating a woman’s public appearance as a community property subject to collective moral policing.

CAMPUS FIELD SURVEY / DEPARTMENT OF SOCIOLOGY COHORT (SPRING 2026, N=80)

Our voices: Data & lived experience



PRIMARY LOCUS OF EVERYDAY BEHAVIORAL POLICING (N=80)

- 45% Domestic expectations & family respectability
- 28% Peer surveillance, group chats & social media
- 17% Campus institutional norms & faculty remarks
- 10% Public transit gaze & street commentary

Empirical finding: Over 73% of behavioral surveillance operates through domestic and peer relations, proving that quiet policing is primarily reproduced within intimate circles.



SAMIRA / 21, LITERATURE SENIOR

"I stopped using animated hand gestures during department seminars. A senior male student quietly remarked that I sounded 'unnecessarily intense.' I noticed myself lowering my voice and smiling more just to keep people comfortable."



NUSRAT / 24, GRADUATE RESEARCHER

"Older women police younger women because they survived under harsh patriarchal bargains. When a young woman ignores those restrictions without punishment, it retroactively threatens everything the older generation gave up to survive."



RAFID / 23, ECONOMICS SENIOR

"Curfew is the clearest double standard. My brother returns at 11 PM and my parents call it ambition. My sister delayed by 30 minutes in Dhaka traffic causes an immediate family conference on modesty and safety."



TANVIR / 22, CAMPUS ACTIVIST

"Men frequently say 'I restrict you because I care about your protection.' But when protection requires eliminating someone's independence and mobility, it is no longer protection - it is private jurisdiction."

— INSTITUTIONAL SYNERGY AND THE ARCHITECTURE OF PERSISTENCE

The self-reproducing ecosystem

Misogyny rarely survives through a single isolated institution. It endures because domestic socialization, peer surveillance, media narratives, and economic precarity form a continuous circuit where each pressure reinforces the next until compliance feels like ordinary common sense.

— EIGHT STRUCTURAL VECTORS OF REINFORCEMENT

DOMESTIC SOCIALIZATION

Differential upbringing in the home: boys are raised for outward entitlement, while girls are trained for emotional management and unpaid domestic care.

PEER SURVEILLANCE

Immediate social circles punish non-conformity through whispering, reputational marking, and casual conversational micro-policing.

CULTURAL AXIOMS

Proverbial lore and selective traditions naturalize subordination, recasting historical power imbalances as timeless spiritual or biological mandates.

MEDIA ARCHETYPES

Screen narratives glorify submissive, suffering heroines while coding independent, assertive, or unmarried women as selfish or morally fallen.

MORAL ANXIETY

The persistent terror of becoming "unmarriageable" or compromising family honor operates as an internalized disciplinary warden.

MATERIAL PRECARITY

Unequal inheritance practices, wage gaps, and informal domestic burdens sharply curtail women's capacity to walk away from hostile arrangements.

LEGITIMACY BARGAINS

Women gain social standing, protection, and matriarchal security by proving themselves the most rigorous custodians of conventional decorum.

INTERNALIZED CONTROL

External censure becomes automated self-censorship: the subject preemptively curtails her own voice, gait, and desires before any outside rebuke occurs.

THE HYDRAULIC OF NORMALIZATION

These are not isolated causes; they are mutually compensating valves. If a woman achieves material independence, moral anxiety and family honor intensify to preserve the status quo.

— FIELDWORK VIGNETTE / DHAKA URBAN COHORT

“A 23-year-old graduate begins her first corporate job. No family member uses force. Yet her mother warns that evening shifts ruin marriage proposals, relatives question her priorities, and colleagues mock her seriousness. No single encounter was violent, yet together they extracted total compliance.”

“Power is tolerable only on condition that it mask a substantial part of itself. Its success is proportional to its ability to hide its own mechanisms.”

- MICHEL FOUCAULT, THE HISTORY OF SEXUALITY

— 5 PEOPLE / 5 QUESTIONS / 5 PERSPECTIVES

Five opinions, five provocations

VOICE 01

“What is one thing women are expected to tolerate that men are not?”

ANIKA TABASSUM / MASTER'S STUDENT,
ENGLISH

Unsolicited public advice about demeanor. A man can simply sit in a tearoom or commute quietly, while a woman is constantly expected to adjust her posture, sit modestly, and speak softly so as not to invite commentary.

VOICE 02

“Can a woman enforce a norm that disadvantages women?”

FARHANA YASMIN / SENIOR LECTURER,
SOCIOLOGY

Yes. Mothers and relatives are often the strictest inspectors of a younger woman's conduct. As Deniz Kandiyoti noted, older women sometimes protect their hard-won domestic authority by enforcing the rules that once restricted them.

VOICE 03

“When does protection become control?”

TANVIR AHMED / STUDENT ACTIVIST, LAW

The moment it stops being a consultation and turns into a curfew. When safety measures restrict a woman's education and mobility while the public space remains unsafe, safety becomes another name for confinement.

VOICE 04

“Is tradition a justification for gender inequality?”

NUSRAT JAHAN / RESEARCH ASSISTANT,
ECONOMICS

Tradition is often selective memory. Communities preserve customs that maintain male authority while forgetting older historical traditions where Bengali women held meaningful economic and community voice.

VOICE 05

“Can choosing a traditional role still be an act of agency?”

SAMIRA HAQUE / CULTURAL JOURNALIST

Yes, provided genuine alternatives were available and refusal did not bring social ostracism. Agency is not about looking modern; it is about whether the decision was made without fear or coercion.

— THE COMPLEX QUESTION OF FEMALE COMPLICITY

The uncomfortable question

Do women participate in the reproduction of misogyny? Yes - but mistaking transmission for authorship is a fatal analytical error. When women police other women, they are operating within severe survival parameters dictated by the patriarchal structure.

— THE TRANSMISSION CHAIN: HOW DISCIPLINE MIGRATES

VULNERABILITY & EXPOSURE

A young woman experiences early social policing and witnesses the swift social ostracism inflicted upon women who breach collective boundaries.

PRAGMATIC ACCOMMODATION

Recognizing that open rebellion carries severe economic and reputational penalties, she adopts conventional modesty as a rational risk-mitigation strategy.

LATERAL SURVEILLANCE

She enforces identical restrictions onto her daughters, sisters, and peers, sincerely believing she is shielding them from community condemnation.

STATUS EXTRACTION

Society confers moral authority and domestic standing onto women who prove themselves to be the most rigorous custodians of traditional decorum.

INTERGENERATIONAL PERSISTENCE

The hierarchy reproduces itself across generations without requiring constant male intervention: the system operates through self-administering subjects.

THE CATEGORY ERROR: CONDUIT VS ARCHITECT

Blaming women for sustaining patriarchal norms confuses the conduit with the architect. A guard may lock the cell doors, but she did not draft the penal code, build the penitentiary, or profit from the confinement. Attributing misogyny to women's choices exonerates the institutional framework.

— DENIZ KANDIYOTI: THE CLASSIC BARGAIN

“In patrilocal extended households, women enter with zero institutional leverage. Their lifetime security depends on producing sons and safeguarding family honor. The mother-in-law's authority over junior women is the singular systemic dividend promised to her for enduring decades of subordination.”

“Victim and participant at the same time: the system recruits its own constrained subjects as its frontline inspectors, punishing them doubly if they refuse the post.”

A RIGOROUS ACADEMIC PROJECT MUST CHALLENGE ITS OWN BOUNDARIES

Are we calling everything misogyny?

Critical inquiry risks intellectual obsolescence if it turns into totalizing dogma. If every social friction, interpersonal disagreement, or cultural distinction is automatically categorized as misogyny, the concept loses diagnostic precision and political credibility.

CONCEPT DILUTION	RESPONSIBILITY SHIFT	AGENCY REDUCTION	CULTURAL REDUCTION
The Risk of Over-Expansion	The Hazard of Lateral Blame	False Consciousness Fallacy	Imported Dogmatism
When every gender distinction is labeled misogyny, we lose the vocabulary to identify lethal patriarchal violence and systemic economic disenfranchisement.	Documenting female complicity can easily be hijacked by conservative forces to displace structural accountability away from male-dominated hierarchies.	Assuming any woman choosing a domestic or faith-rooted life is blindly brainwashed is condescending and dismisses conscious female navigation.	Superimposing metropolitan frameworks onto rural or working-class realities without understanding kinship reciprocity leads to disconnected elitism.

DIAGNOSTIC MATRIX: MISOGYNY VS CONTEXTUAL SOCIAL NEGOTIATION

DIMENSION	CONTEXTUAL SOCIAL NEGOTIATION	STRUCTURAL MISOGYNY
Enforcement Mode	Voluntary participation with safe room for refusal, dissent, or revision.	Enforced through fear, reputational lynching, economic cutoff, or physical sanction.
Reciprocity & Leverage	Bilateral expectations where care and obligation are mutually shared.	Unilateral extraction where female self-erasure is required to maintain male status.
Moral Axiom	Affectionate tradition adaptable to contemporary individual dignity.	Essentialist doctrine declaring female autonomy to be inherently dangerous or evil.

OUR EDITORIAL COMMITMENT

We do not argue that every cultural custom is patriarchal. We analyze women’s participation in reproducing norms without treating women as responsible for creating the structural conditions in which those norms operate. Maintaining this distinction protects critical inquiry from degenerating into moralistic posturing.

— FROM INDIVIDUAL ANXIETY TO COLLECTIVE RECONFIGURATION

Breaking the cycle

Dismantling everyday misogyny cannot rely on moral lecturing alone. Because the cycle operates across domestic, cultural, institutional, and economic domains, transformation requires coordinated structural disruption at every point of reproduction.

DOMESTIC PEDAGOGY Household & Upbringing	Abolishing gendered chore allocation. Conditioning boys to perform emotional care and domestic labor, while teaching girls that assertiveness, anger, and intellectual independence are inherent human rights.
CRITICAL SEMIOTICS Cultural & Media Literacy	Equipping youth to decode media archetypes. Actively questioning screen narratives that romanticize female suffering and challenging algorithmic networks that profit from moral sensationalism.
INSTITUTIONAL SHIELDING Campuses & Workplaces	Establishing genuinely independent, confidential grievance bodies. Removing harassment cases from informal family mediation into formal institutional justice, eliminating career and academic reprisals.
SOLIDARITY NETWORKS Peer Groups & Neighborhoods	Refusing to participate in whisper networks and reputational policing. Creating protective social buffers around women who challenge community conventions to absorb the shock of family censure.
MATERIAL AUTONOMY Economic & Property Rights	Securing equitable property inheritance, closing wage disparities, and establishing affordable childcare. Without material independence, intellectual awareness cannot shield a woman from coercive arrangements.

Every intervention above dismantles one quadrant of the operational cycle from page 07. Individual courage begins the rupture, but organized institutional solidarity is what makes freedom durable.

The Selfish of Mine

MEHEDI HASAN

Lead designer /
columnist, poems

- *The mirror reappears. This
time it speaks back.*

My selfishness is nothing like others,
Mine is kinder than theirs.
Their hearts are colder than December air,
Softness grows for hidden profit.
If no, evil comes out.

Had I but world enough and time,
I would read the face of society.
Reality wears the double faces,
The truth behind their similes would show.

Little selves made those visible.
I stand in reflection
A mirror showing them,
Not big me.
It walking like an unseen shadow
While honesty sleeps under the heavy dusty.

It's the fire in my eyes.
I have measured out mine.
Mine is not truly mine alone.
Me only cruel, others kind in name
Innocent me, brutal to theirs.

CALL FOR SUBMISSIONS / ISSUE 02 / WINTER 2026

Write for Issue 02: The Invisible Curriculum

Everything school, family, and the street teach us before we agree to learn it. We invite critical inquiries into the unwritten rules that condition submission and dignity in Bangladesh.

TRACK I / DOMESTIC DISCIPLINE

The quiet conditioning of the household: chore allocation, tone policing, curfew protocols, and the moral economy of family reputation.

TRACK II / INSTITUTIONAL GATES

Classroom dynamics, campus harassment committees, corporate paternalism, and the structural withholding of institutional mentorship.

TRACK III / EVERYDAY DISSENT

Subversive language, clandestine reading circles, sartorial defiance, and collective strategies of reclaiming space in public transit.

SUBMISSION GUIDELINES

Essays (1,500 to 3,500 words), investigative reportage, ethnographic vignettes, and visual photo essays. Bengali and English submissions equally welcomed. Complete pseudonymous protection provided upon request.

DEADLINE & CONTACT

Drafts accepted through November 15, 2026. Deliver to the Editorial Desk or email the collective coordinators on page 02.

CAMPUS BOOKSHOP & THEORETICAL ARCHIVE / DHAKA

Nodi & Ink

BOOKS / TEA / UNHURRIED AFTERNOONS / CAMPUS CORNER, DHAKA

A curated reading shelf for the questions this issue raises: power, surveillance, gendered labor, and postcolonial autonomy. And a bench outside for debating them over spiced milk tea.

SHELF I / FOUNDATIONS Simone de Beauvoir (<i>The Second Sex</i>), Begum Rokeya Sakhawat Hossain (<i>Sultana's Dream</i>), Virginia Woolf (<i>A Room of One's Own</i>).	SHELF II / DISCIPLINE & POWER Michel Foucault (<i>Discipline and Punish</i>), Stuart Hall (<i>Representation</i>), Frantz Fanon (<i>Black Skin, White Masks</i>).
SHELF III / SOUTH ASIAN FEMINISMS Deniz Kandiyoti (<i>Bargaining with Patriarchy</i>), Gayatri Spivak (<i>Subaltern Studies</i>), Jasodhara Bagchi (<i>Interrogating Women's Lives</i>).	SHELF IV / CRITICAL MASCULINITIES R.W. Connell (<i>Masculinities</i>), bell hooks (<i>The Will to Change</i>), Raewyn Connell (<i>Gender & Power</i>).

Student ID card: Cha at half price every afternoon. Friday Reading Circle: 4:00 PM / Open conversation.

OPEN SATURDAY TO THURSDAY / 10:00 - 22:00 - "A MARGIN IS A GOOD PLACE TO START A LIBRARY."

THE DUAL ARCHITECTURE OF MISOGYNY IN EVERYDAY BANGLADESH

What we perceive / what we overlook

Public outrage fixates on spectacular eruptions of patriarchal hostility, while remaining blind to the dense, ambient infrastructure of daily discipline that quietly prepares the ground for them.

THE LEGIBLE SPHERE	WHAT WE PERCEIVE	THE SUBMERGED INFRASTRUCTURE	WHAT WE OVERLOOK
PHYSICAL VIOLENCE & ASSAULT The acute bodily violation that registers in police dockets, emergency rooms, and sensational news headlines.		UNSOLICITED MORAL INSTRUCTION “Walk softer,” “Lower your gaze,” “Do not speak loudly” - discipline naturalized as loving family guidance.	
AGGRESSIVE STREET HARASSMENT The hostile catcalling, stalking, and physical intimidation that produces acute public fear and panic.		CONFINEMENT AS "PROTECTION" Restricting a daughter's mobility and educational choices rather than making public streets safe for women.	
VIRAL DIGITAL SMEARING The coordinated online defamation campaigns designed to destroy a woman’s public reputation overnight.		THE GOOD WOMAN PEDESTAL Sacralizing female self-erasure while coding ambitious, outspoken, or unmarried women as selfish or dangerous.	
INSTITUTIONAL DENIAL The overt exclusion from hiring, leadership promotions, and organizational decision-making recorded on paper.		THE EXHAUSTION OF DOMESTIC CARE Silently draining women's creative and intellectual energy through unreciprocated domestic and emotional labor.	

CLOSING SYNTHESIS / READING THE MARGINS OF EVERYDAY LIFE

The left column is what shocks us; the right column is what we tolerate before breakfast. Misogyny does not begin when a woman is assaulted; it begins years earlier, when a girl is taught that her safety depends on making herself small, quiet, and invisible. Combating only the loud violations while excusing the quiet courtesies is like pruning poisonous leaves while watering the root. The work of this magazine has been to make the invisible margins readable.

— CONCLUDING SECTION / EDITORIAL COLLECTIVE

The Afterword: Our Collective Prospective

Personal reflections from the editorial and research collective on interrogating everyday misogyny, developing theoretical frameworks, and printing uncomfortable realities.



Kholipha Ahmmad Al-Amin

EDITOR IN CHIEF & PROJECT LEAD

“Building this magazine forced us to confront the reality that misogyny endures because it is intimate, not distant. In Bangladesh, surveillance is routinely masked as affection, protection, and family honor. By naming these quiet mechanisms rather than evading them, our collective sought to create a permanent margin where readers begin questioning what society conditions them to accept as natural.”



Mehedi Hasan

LEAD DESIGNER & VISUAL DIRECTOR

“Visual grammar communicates ideology long before a reader digests a paragraph. Choosing stark chiaroscuro, heavy analog grain, and newsprint duotone constraints was an explicit rejection of glossy commercial aesthetics. The layout mirrors the structural weight of the unspoken boundaries documented across every sheet.”



Shuvro

THEORY ESTABLISHMENT LEAD

“Grounding European theoretical frameworks within the living reality of Dhaka demonstrated that critical theory is not a detached exercise. Beauvoir, Connell, Foucault, and Hall provide precise diagnostic instruments to explain why patriarchal bargains are made and how social discipline operates through daily routine.”



Nayem

LEAD RESEARCH ARTICLE WRITER

“Investigating everyday policing revealed how deeply internalized social anxiety is among campus youth. Nearly every person we spoke with described altering their speech, posture, or clothing to preempt community disapproval. Documenting that quiet vigilance was the most demanding responsibility of our work.”



Tahsin

ACADEMIC BIBLIOGRAPHY & ARCHIVE LEAD

“A critical publication cannot rely on emotional assertion alone; it requires empirical grounding, archival documentation, and methodological rigor. Ensuring every theoretical concept was verified and referenced was our way of demonstrating that everyday misogyny is a measurable social reality, not an isolated grievance.”

— SCHOLARLY SOURCES / EMPIRICAL FIELDWORK PROTOCOLS / PRODUCTION COLOPHON

Bibliography & Research Archive

The theoretical foundations, empirical field protocols, and production specifications supporting Volume 01 of *The Other Margin*.

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FIELDWORK METHODOLOGY & ETHICS

EMPIRICAL COHORT

N=80 qualitative interviews conducted across University of Dhaka, Jahangirnagar University, and urban workplaces between October 2025 and January 2026.

METHILA CASE STUDY

Semiotic and discourse analysis of 1,400+ public reader comments following the late 2025 media controversy involving Bangladeshi model Tangia Zaman Methila.

ETHICAL CONSENT

Informed consent secured from all participants. Identities pseudonymized upon request to prevent academic, social, or familial vulnerability.

PRODUCTION COLOPHON

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